for the TTP. Moreover, the federal government of Pakistan remained ambivalent in tackling it. The security forces of Pakistan carried out operations against the local militants in 2002 to prevent them from providing protection to Afghan Taliban and Al Qaeda in North and South Waziristan. However, it started relying on negotiations a bit too early. Hence, the TTP gained strength and became a menace for Pakistan.

On 25 August 2008, the government of Pakistan imposed a ban on TTP, froze its bank accounts and assets and barred it from media appearances. The government also announced bounties on its prominent leaders (*The News International*, 2008). However, such bans and bars had little effect on the terrorist organisations like TTP, which have no offices and bank accounts as well as do not make public appearances. It only created awareness among the public and gave authority to announce head money on their wanted militants. The TTP continued to operate and flourish. It intensified its insurgency in FATA and Swat and conducted horrendous terrorism across Pakistan continuously.

STRUCTURE AND SYSTEM OF TTP

Most TTP fighters were not intransigent ideological extremists, but belonged to different segments with different reasons for joining the TTP:

1. A large number of unemployed youth in FATA, who were recruited on payment of Rs 15,000–20,000 per month (sterling 100–120);
2. Criminals, who were lured by incentives, gun and legitimacy to operate;
3. Hardcore extremists of proscribed sectarian and jihadi organisations such as SSP, LJ and JeM;
4. Angry and aggrieved relatives of those who were killed in military operations and drone attacks (*Times*, 2009).

There was a general opinion that the TTP was combined of bedraggled illiterate tribesmen living in remote areas who had little knowledge about modern life and warfare; however, that was an incorrect impression. The TTP had developed itself into a well-organised force, which had